Microsoft 365 Copilot Analytics

Analyst Playbook

Advanced Analytics & Power BI workflows for Insights Analysts

Document Property	Value
Layer	3 — Operate
Audience	Insights Analyst
Version	4.0
Published	April 2026

How This Document Fits

This is a **Layer 3 — Operate** document. It walks Insights Analysts through creating Copilot analytics queries, connecting Power BI templates, and publishing reports to leaders. It does **not** cover initial admin configuration — see the Admin Setup Guide for that.

Layer	Purpose	Who Reads
1 — Strategy	Decide what to implement	CIO, SA, Business Leaders
2 — Setup	Configure and deploy	IT Admin, Insights Admin
3 — Operate (you are here)	Use dashboards and reports daily	Leaders, Analysts, Managers
4 — Reference	Look up details and fix issues	Everyone (as needed)

Table of Contents

1. Prerequisites

2. Available Copilot PBI Templates
3. Step-by-Step: Create a Report
4. Connect Power BI
5. Publish Reports to Leaders
6. Ongoing Maintenance
7. Analyst Departure — Transfer Guide
8. What to Read Next

1. Prerequisites

Before you can create Copilot analytics queries and connect Power BI templates, the following must be in place:

Prerequisite	Details
Viva Insights licence	Minimum 50 licences in the tenant. Included with M365 Copilot licences — no separate purc
Insights Analyst role	Must be assigned to your account by an Insights Admin or Global Admin via the Microsoft 36
Partition access	An Insights Admin must grant you access to the relevant partition(s). Without partition acces
Org data uploaded	Organisational data (department, agency, location, etc.) must be uploaded for segmentation
Power BI Desktop	June 2022 or later. Required to open `.pbit` template files downloaded from Viva Insights.

> **Insights Admin ≠ Insights Analyst**
>
> These are **different roles** with different permissions. The **Insights Admin** configures the system (uploads org data, creates partitions, manages access). The **Insights Analyst** runs queries and builds reports. You need the **Analyst** role to follow this playbook. If you have the Admin role but not the Analyst role, ask your Global Admin to assign both.

Data Requirements

Timing matters. Plan your data collection window *before* Copilot rolls out if you need before/after analysis:

Data Requirement	Minimum	Notes
Org data upload	Required	Enables segmentation by department, agency, location, job function, and othe
Pre-adoption baseline	4 weeks	Needed for before/after comparison in the Copilot Impact template. Must be c
Post-adoption data	4 weeks	Minimum period after Copilot rollout for meaningful usage patterns to emerge.

Plan Ahead for Before/After Analysis

If Copilot has already been rolled out across your tenant, **before/after comparison may not be possible**. The Impact template requires pre-adoption collaboration data as a baseline. Plan your analytics strategy *before* licence assignment to ensure you capture baseline data.

2. Available Copilot PBI Templates

Microsoft provides several Power BI templates purpose-built for Copilot analytics. Each template creates a pre-built query with predefined metrics and a corresponding `.pbit` file for Power BI Desktop.

Template	Purpose	Key Metrics
M365 Copilot Impact	Primary ROI and productivity analysis	Assisted hours, assiste
M365 Copilot Adoption	Usage trends and feature adoption depth	Active users over time,
Copilot Headlines (preview)	Auto-scanned executive insights	Power users, adoption
Copilot Business Impact	Correlate Copilot usage with business outcomes	Business KPI correlatio
Copilot Studio Agents	Agent usage and impact analysis	Agent session outcome
Copilot Employee Experience (Glint)	Correlate Copilot usage with employee sentiment	Usage patterns mappe

> **Template Availability**
>
> Not all templates may be visible in your tenant. Templates appear based on your licence entitlements, feature rollout status, and whether prerequisites (e.g., Glint licence, business data upload) are met. Check Microsoft Learn for the latest template availability.

3. Step-by-Step: Create a Report

This walkthrough uses the **M365 Copilot Impact** template as the example, but the process is similar for all templates.

Step 1 — Sign In to the Analyst Experience

Navigate to **analysis.insights.viva.office.com** and sign in with your organisational account that has the Insights Analyst role.

Step 2 — Start a New Analysis

Select **Create analysis** → **Templates** → **Copilot** → choose the desired template (e.g., *M365 Copilot Impact*) → **Set up analysis**.

Step 3 — Configure Query Settings

Set the following:

- **Query name** — use a descriptive name (e.g., "Copilot Impact Q1 2026 — All Agencies")
- **Time period** — select the analysis window (up to 13 months of historical data)
- **Auto-refresh** — enable if you want the query to re-run automatically on a schedule
- **Description** — optional but recommended for team documentation

Step 4 — Review Predefined Metrics

The template pre-selects the required metrics (shown as grey tags — these cannot be removed). You can optionally add extra metrics to include in the query output.

Step 5 — Set Employee Filters

Apply filters to scope the query population:

- **"Is Active"** — always recommended to exclude departed employees
- **Org attributes** — filter by department, agency, location, or any uploaded org data attribute as needed

Step 6 — Add Organisational Attributes

Select up to **20 organisational attributes** to include in the query output. These attributes become available as group-by and filter dimensions in Power BI. Include any attribute you may want to slice by later — you cannot add them after the query runs.

Step 7 — Run the Query

Select **Run**. Depending on population size and time window, the query may take minutes to hours to complete. You will receive a notification when results are ready.

> **Data Quality Warnings**
>
> During query setup, the system may flag data quality issues:
>
> - **Yellow warning** — low quality or partial coverage for an attribute. The query will still run.
> - **Red warning** — missing attribute entirely. The query will run but that attribute will not be usable for segmentation.
>
> Address data quality issues by working with your Insights Admin to update the org data upload.

4. Connect Power BI

Once your query completes, connect it to the Power BI template:

Step 1 — Download the Template

From the query results page in Viva Insights, download the `.pbit` template file.

Step 2 — Open in Power BI Desktop

Open the downloaded `.pbit` file in Power BI Desktop. When prompted, paste:

- **Partition ID** — found in the Viva Insights analyst experience
- **Query ID** — found on the query results page

Step 3 — Set Minimum Group Size

Set the minimum group size for privacy thresholds (e.g., 10). Groups smaller than this threshold will be suppressed in the report. Click **Load**.

Step 4 — Sign In

When prompted for credentials, select **Organisational account** and sign in with the same account used to run the query.

Step 5 — Configure Report Settings

After data loads, configure the report settings on the Settings page:

- **Time period** — define the reporting window within the query's date range
- **Group-by attribute** — select the primary organisational attribute for segmentation (e.g., Department, Agency)
- **Active user definition** — set the threshold for what constitutes an "active" Copilot user
- **Language** — set report language

Explore the Report Pages

The Copilot Impact template includes several pre-built pages:

- **Summary** — high-level overview of Copilot impact across the organisation
- **Before vs After** — compares collaboration patterns before and after Copilot adoption
- **Copilot vs Non-Copilot** — compares metrics between users with and without Copilot licences
- **Two-Group Comparison** — compare two organisational segments side by side
- **Research Insights** — deeper statistical analysis and trend exploration

5. Publish Reports to Leaders

You can share query results with business leaders directly from Viva Insights using the **Publish** feature.

Step 1 — Select Publish

In the Viva Insights analyst experience, navigate to your completed query and select **Publish**.

Step 2 — Set Report Metadata

Enter:

- **Title** — the report title that recipients will see
- **Publisher name** — your name or team name
- **Description** — brief summary of what the report covers

Step 3 — Choose Scope

Select one of:

- **Unfiltered original** — publishes the full dataset. All recipients see the same data.
- **Filter by manager hierarchy** — each recipient sees only data for their reporting line.

Step 4 — Set Expiry Date

Set when the published report expires. Maximum is **365 days** from publication.

Step 5 — Publish

Confirm and publish. Recipients receive an email notification with a link to view the report.

> **No Auto-Notification Before Expiry**
>
> Published reports expire silently — there is **no automatic notification** sent before a report expires. Set a calendar reminder to re-publish before the expiry date to avoid gaps in leader access.

Multi-Agency Tenants: Manager Hierarchy Risk

Choosing **“Filter by manager hierarchy”** grants **any enabled manager** dashboard access to their reporting line’s data. In multi-agency tenants, this may unintentionally expose data across agency boundaries. **Use Power BI workspaces instead** for controlled distribution in multi-agency deployments — see the Multi-Agency Setup Guide for details.

6. Ongoing Maintenance

Keep your Copilot analytics current with these recurring tasks:

- **Refresh org data monthly** — work with your Insights Admin to ensure organisational data (new hires, transfers, departures) stays up to date. Stale org data leads to inaccurate segmentation.
- **Re-run queries periodically** — either enable auto-refresh during query setup or manually re-run queries on a monthly or quarterly cadence to capture current trends.
- **Update PBI reports** — when Microsoft releases updated template versions, download the new `.pbit` and reconnect to benefit from new metrics and visualisations.
- **Share via Publish Reports or Power BI workspaces** — for ongoing distribution, either re-publish through Viva Insights or save `.pbix` files to a shared Power BI workspace where leaders can access them directly.

7. Analyst Departure — Transfer Guide

When an Insights Analyst leaves the organisation or changes roles, follow this checklist to ensure continuity:

Item	What Happens
Completed query results	Persist in Viva Insights — a new analyst with partition access can view them
Scheduled / recurring queries	May stop running when the account is disabled or deleted
Published reports	Remain accessible until their expiry date, but **cannot be renewed** by a different an
Power BI files (.pbix)	Stored locally on the analyst's machine — lost if not transferred
Partition access	Role assignment is per-user — does not transfer automatically

> **Redundancy Is Essential**
>
> Always have **at least two analysts** with partition access. Store all `.pbix` files in a shared Power BI workspace rather than on individual machines. This prevents data loss and reporting gaps during transitions.

8. What to Read Next

Document	When to Read
Dashboard & Reports Guide	You want to understand the Copilot Dashboard metrics and pages that leaders see
Data Onboarding Guide	You need to prepare or update the organisational data upload
Attribute Reference	You need the full list of org data attributes and their mapping rules
Troubleshooting Guide	Something isn’t working — query failures, missing data, or access issues

Disclaimer: This document is provided for informational purposes only and reflects Microsoft 365 capabilities as of April 2026. Microsoft may change features, interfaces, and availability without notice. Always verify current guidance on Microsoft Learn. This document is not official Microsoft documentation and should not be treated as a definitive source for product capabilities or licensing requirements.